

Lecture 3

Article Reading

- **Mother Tongue:**
[the article](#).
- **Spanglish Spoken Here:**
- **Activity 1:**
 - Task 1: the debate of two professors about the world English and standard English

Summary

- **The Features of Expository Writing**
 - **Objectivity:**
Providing the neutral reference from the third position.
 - **Formality:**
Avoiding the use of oral expressions and abbreviated forms for scientific or academic purpose.
 - **Complexity:**
lexically dense, varied vocabulary, more subordinate clauses, more passive sentence...
 - **Hedging:**
for mitigating the force with which propositions are expressed or refraining from the commitment.(vague language, cautious language or tentative language and with softening modifiers)

Hedging

What is hedging

An expression used to allow for **additional possibilities** or to **avoid over precise commitment**.
(often, usually)

Why use hedging language

Present the **true state** of the writer's understanding and may be used to negotiate an **accurate representation** of the state of the knowledge under discussion.

Render the statement **less vulnerable to opposition**.

Appear humble.

Related representation

Introductory verbs

tend to/assume/indicate/estimate/seem to/appear to be/doubt/believe/suggest

Adverbs

probably/possibly/seemingly/apparently/perhaps/maybe/presumably/conceivably

Modal Verbs

may/might/can/could

Adjectives

probable/possible/likely/doubtful/unlikely/uncertain

Nouns

probability/possibility/likelihood/assumption/tendency/indication/estimate/evidence/claim

Other Phrases

sometimes/often/generally/commonly/frequently/approximately/somewhat

It is generally agreed that/In our opinion/In our view

if true/if anything